"IN THE BEGINNING..."

GENESIS 25

IN 5 MINUTES

When:

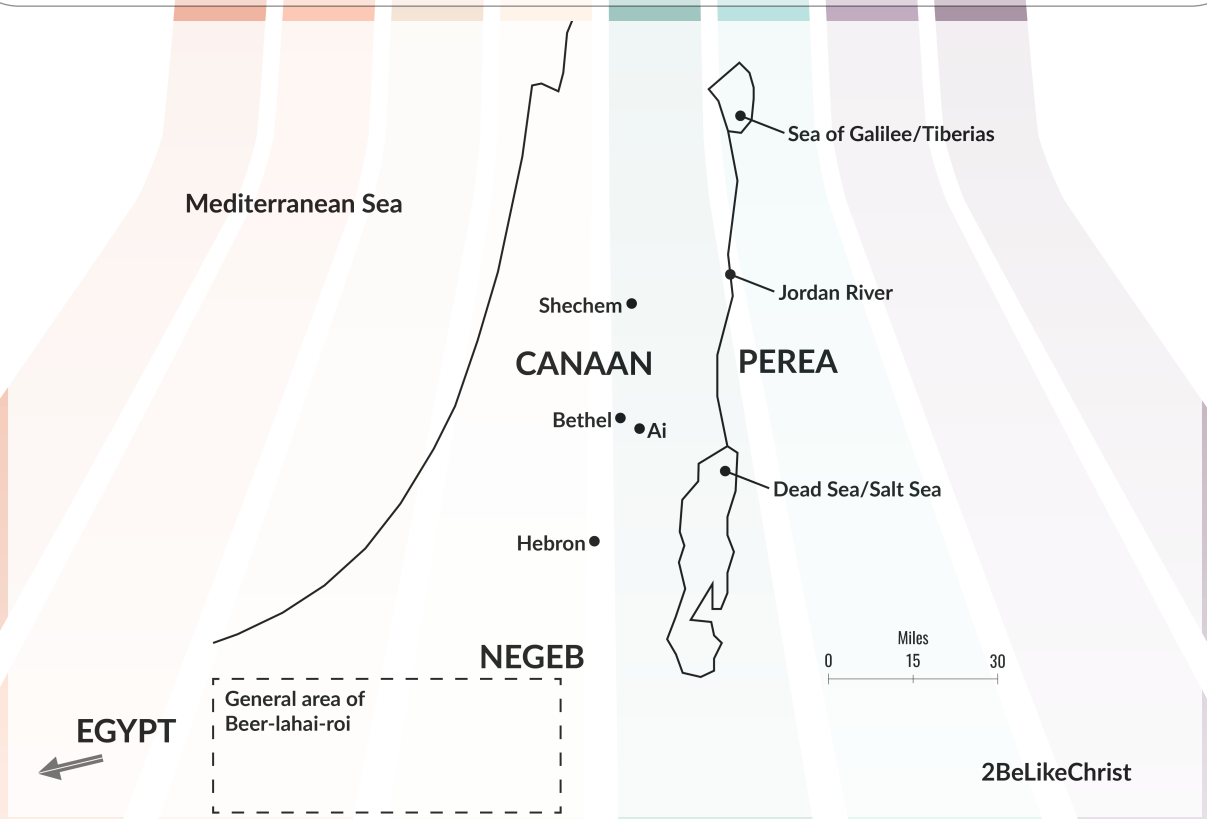
- Abram was born in approximately 1996 B.C. and died in 1821 B.C. at 175 years old (Gen 25:7). According to Genesis 25:20, Isaac was 40 years old when he married Rebekah (1856 B.C.). Genesis 25:26 tells us Isaac was 60 years old when Esau and Jacob were born (1836 B.C.).

Characters:

- Abraham – A man from Ur of the Chaldeans who moved to Canaan at God's instruction. God promised to make his descendants a great nation and to give them the land of Canaan.
- Ishmael – Abraham's son with Hagar, Sarah's Egyptian servant.
- Isaac – Abraham's son with Sarah.
- Rebekah – Isaac's wife, the daughter of Bethuel.
- Jacob and Esau – Twin brothers born to Isaac and Rebekah.

Where:

- Isaac lived in Beer-lahai-roi. Ishmael's family lived between Havilah and Shur (south of the Negeb).



Outline:

- THE FINAL YEARS OF ABRAHAM (25:1-11):
    + Abraham married a woman named Keturah and she bore him 5 sons.
    + Abraham's son, Isaac, inherited his household.
    + All of Abraham's children with his concubines were sent away to live in the east country before his death.
    + Abraham died at 175 years old and was buried by Isaac and Ishmael in the cave of Machpelah with Sarah.
    + After his father's death, Isaac settled at Beer-lahai-roi.
- THE FAMILY OF ISHMAEL (25:12-18):
    + Ishmael, Abraham's son with Hagar, fathered 12 sons who became 12 princes.
    + Ishmael was 137 years old when he died.
    + His descendants settled between Havilah and Shur.
- JACOB AND ESAU, THE CHILDREN OF ISAAC (25:19-28):
    + Rebekah, Isaac's wife, was barren, so Isaac prayed for her.
    + The Lord heard Isaac's prayer and Rebekah conceived twins.
    + The Lord said to her, "Two nations are in your womb, and two peoples from within you shall be divided; the one shall be stronger than the other, the older shall serve the younger."
    + The firstborn was named Esau and the second child, who came out grasping the heal of his brother, was named Jacob.
    + Isaac loved Esau but Rebekah loved Jacob.
- ESAU'S BIRTHRIGHT (25:29-34):
    + Once, when Jacob was preparing stew, Esau returned from hunting and was extremely hungry.
    + He asked Jacob to give him some of the "red stew."
    + Jacob told him he could have it in exchange for his birthright.
    + Believing himself on the brink of starvation, Esau agreed to sell his birthright, and Jacob gave him the food.

Application:

- Esau's decision to sell his birthright is not spoken of highly in the scriptures. Genesis 25:34 says, "Esau despised his birthright" and Hebrews 12:16 rebukes Esau for his poor decision.
- Esau was a fool because he traded a great blessing for something of little value.
- Do we do the same thing?
- When we "dispise" God's offer of salvation because we don't want to give up our petty earthly pleasures, we are making a terrible trade.
- Esau grew to regret his trade, and we will too if we trade an eternity with God for a few years of earthly fun.